



FUNDAMENTALS OF OPEN SOURCE IT AND CLOUD COM...

WHAT IS LINUX?

Linux as an Operating System

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Linux is a free, open source operating system which has now grown to run on a large number of physical computer architectures. For example, almost all major websites, including Google, Facebook, and Wikipedia, and most of the cloud runs on Linux; all 500 of the world's fastest supercomputers run Linux; and the Android phone operating system is based on the Linux Kernel. Mainframes have long run Linux, and even your refrigerator and many other devices we use daily may run Linux.

While Linux was originally based on the UNIX operating system, it was written from scratch by Linus Torvalds with assistance from a loosely-knit team of developers across the Net. It aims towards POSIX and Single UNIX Specification compliance where possible.

Linux has all the features you would expect in a modern, fully-fledged UNIX operating system, including true multitasking, virtual memory, shared libraries, demand loading, shared copy-on-write executables, proper memory management, and multi-stack networking, including IPv4 and IPv6.

Linux is distributed under the GNU General Public License, version 2 (GPLv2).

To learn more about Linux and its history, check out:

- *Linux turns 30: Linus Torvalds on his "just a hobby" operating system*, by Steven J. Vaughan-Nichols (August 25, 2021)
- *What Is Linux?*
- *The Linux Kernel Archives*